

HOW QUOTEMAX **PRICES** A JOB

How a quote is built — from the customer's call or text, through the AI engines, into the price database, and back as a quote. What the AI does, what the database does, and where the line between them sits.

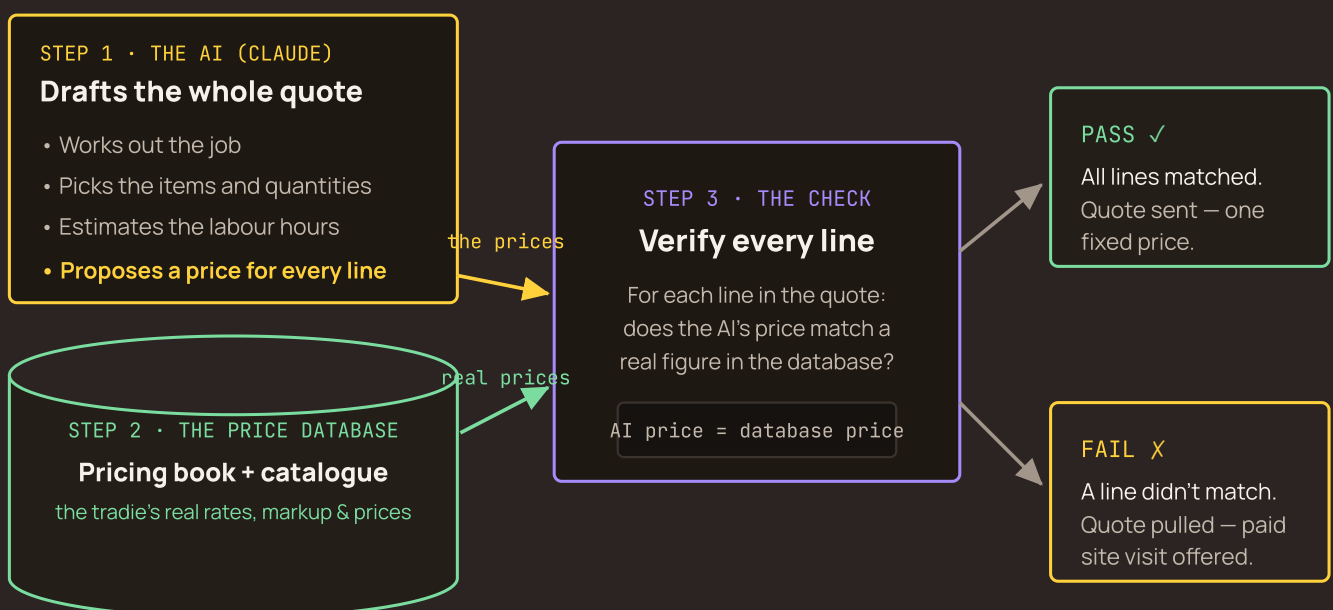
01 • THE SHORT ANSWER

DOES THE AI SET THE PRICE?

The AI drafts the quote and proposes the numbers. A separate, non-AI check then verifies every price against the tradie's price list.

If a price doesn't match the list, the whole quote is rejected and the customer is offered a paid site visit. **A made-up price cannot reach a customer.**

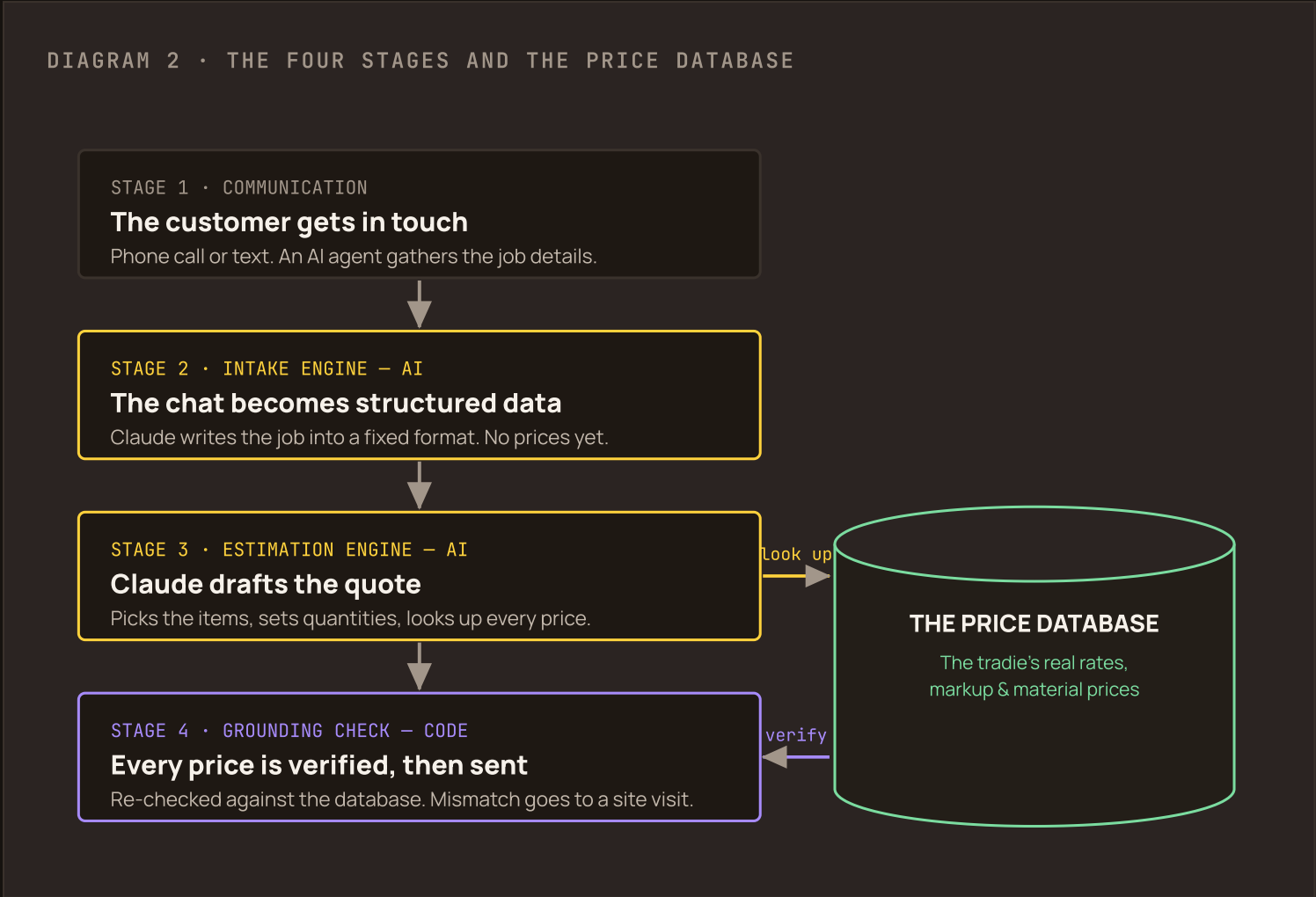
DIAGRAM 1 • THE AI PROPOSES — THE DATABASE VERIFIES — THE CHECK DECIDES



Every line of every quote is checked. A price that isn't in the database cannot be sent.

FROM CALL TO QUOTE — FOUR STAGES

A quote passes through four stages. Two are run by the AI, one is the conversation, and the last is plain code. The price database sits beside them.



STAGE 1 • COMMUNICATION

The customer explains the job

A phone call or text. On SMS an AI agent runs the chat and keeps asking until it has the details a quote needs. Nothing is priced here.

STAGE 2 • INTAKE ENGINE — AI

The conversation becomes structured data

Claude reads the transcript and photos and records the job in a fixed format — type, item count, scope, access, risks. This is the AI's reading of the job; still no prices.

STAGE 3 • ESTIMATION ENGINE — AI

Claude drafts the quote and looks up the prices

Claude picks the items, sets quantities and labour hours, and looks up each price from the database. It then writes the full quote draft as one clear fixed price.

STAGE 4 • GROUNDING CHECK – PLAIN CODE

Every price is verified against the database

Non-AI code re-checks each price against the database. All match — the quote is sent. Any mismatch — the whole quote becomes a paid site visit. This is what makes the pricing trustworthy.

03 • FOLLOW ONE JOB

ONE JOB, START TO FINISH

The clearest view is one real job followed all the way through — a customer texting in to replace some downlights.

1 THE CUSTOMER TEXTS IN

COMMUNICATION

CUSTOMER

Hi, I need some downlights replaced please

QUOTEMAX AI

Happy to help. How many downlights, and which rooms are they in?

CUSTOMER

6 of them, old halogen ones. Hallway and the living room.

QUOTEMAX AI

Great. Is the existing wiring staying, and is there roof-space access above the ceiling?

CUSTOMER

Yeah just reuse the wiring, normal ceiling with roof access. Warm white please.

QUOTEMAX AI

Perfect — that's everything I need. I'll put your quote together now.

The AI agent gathers details until it has enough. Nothing is priced yet.

2 THE INTAKE ENGINE TURNS THE CHAT INTO DATA

INTAKE ENGINE · AI

Claude writes the job down in a fixed format. This is the exact record it produces:

```
{
  "trade": "electrical",
  "job_type": "downlights",
  "suburb": "Parramatta NSW",
  "scope": {
    "description": "Replace 6 halogen downlights with LED, hallway and living room,",
    "item_count": 6,
    "specs": { "color_temp": "warm_white" }
  },
  "access": { "ceiling_type": "standard", "roof_access": true, "existing_wiring": t
  "risks": [],
  "inspection_required": false,
  "caller": { "name": "Sarah" },
  "confidence": "HIGH"
}
```

Every value is the AI's reading of the chat. Still no prices.

3 THE ESTIMATION ENGINE LOOKS UP PRICES AND DRAFTS THE QUOTE

ESTIMATION ENGINE · AI

Claude calls lookup tools that read straight from the price list and catalogue — it cannot price anything without them:

```
lookup_assembly("install LED downlight")
└─ DATABASE returns "Install LED downlight" · 0.5 hr labour per light

lookup_material("warm white LED downlight")
└─ DATABASE returns 3 catalogue rows, raw prices:
    Basic LED downlight ..... $28.00
    Tri-colour LED downlight ..... $44.00
    Dimmable IP-rated downlight .. $72.00

apply_markup($28.00, markup 28%)
└─ returns $35.84 (28% markup — from the tradie's pricing book)
```

With real prices in hand, it drafts the **fixed-price** quote:

LINE ITEM	QTY	UNIT PRICE EX-GST	TOTAL
Basic LED downlight — warm white priced from catalogue \$28.00 + 28% markup	6	\$35.84	\$215.04
Install downlights — cut, terminate & fit 3.0 hr at the pricing-book labour rate	3.0 hr	\$110.00	\$330.00
Subtotal ex-GST			\$545.04

Every line on the quote is built the same way — looked up, then verified.

4 THE GROUNDING CHECK VERIFIES EVERY PRICE

GROUNDING CHECK · PLAIN CODE

Non-AI code re-checks each line against the database:

- ✓ **\$35.84 per downlight** — matches catalogue "Basic LED downlight" (\$28.00) plus the tradie's 28% markup.
- ✓ **\$110.00 / hr labour** — matches the pricing book's hourly rate exactly.
- ✓ **3.0 hr labour total** — above the tradie's 2.0 hr minimum-job rule.

All lines verified — the quote is sent. One mismatch would have sent it to a paid site visit instead.

5 SARAH RECEIVES THE QUOTE

DELIVERED

One clear fixed price, by text — every figure already verified, no haggling:

YOUR FIXED PRICE

Warm-white LED
downlights, supplied & fitted

\$599.54

inc-GST · \$545.04 ex

Every price came from the database. The item count and labour hours came from the AI's reading of Sarah's messages.

WHAT'S THE AI, WHAT'S THE DATABASE

Every part of a quote, and how much of it is checked against the database.

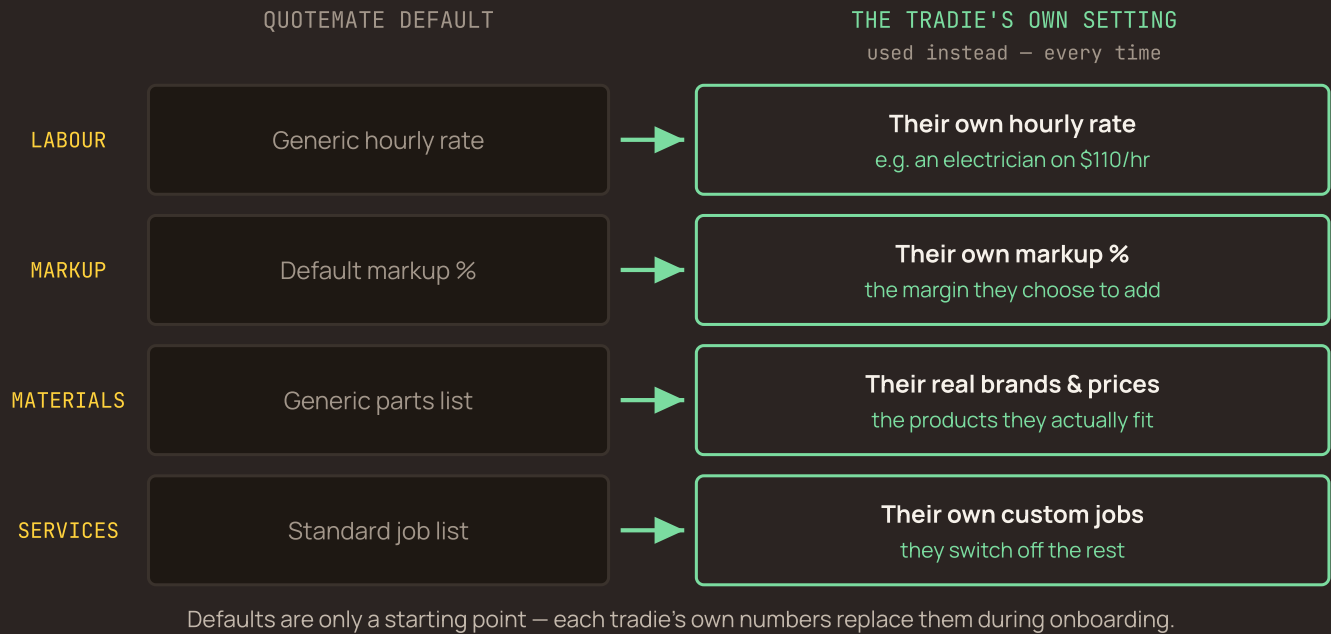
PART OF THE QUOTE	WHO CREATES IT	CHECKED AGAINST THE DATABASE?
What the job is	AI · intake engine	AI'S READING Its interpretation of the conversation.
How many items	AI · intake engine	AI'S READING Taken from what the customer said.
Which items are quoted	AI · estimation engine	PARTLY The item must exist in the catalogue.
Labour hours	AI · estimation engine	MINIMUM ONLY Must meet the minimum-job hours; exact hours are estimated.
Hourly labour rate	Database	DB-VERIFIED Must equal the tradie's rate exactly.
Each material's price	AI looks it up · DB supplies it	DB-VERIFIED Must match a real price-list row.
The markup added	Database value	DB-VERIFIED Must be the tradie's markup.
Call-out fee & GST	Database / fixed	DB-VERIFIED Set figures the AI cannot change.
Wording & quote framing	AI · estimation engine	AI-WRITTEN Text, not a number.

In short: **the rates and prices are locked to the database** — the AI cannot send a made-up rate. But **the size of the job** — item counts and labour hours — is the AI's estimate of what the customer described.

WHERE THE TRADIE'S PRICES TAKE OVER

QuoteMax ships a shared default price list so a new tradie isn't blank on day one. Each tradie's own numbers replace it — and the tradie's numbers always win.

DIAGRAM 3 • THE SHARED DEFAULT VS. THE TRADIE'S OWN SETTING



06 • THE REAL GUARANTEES

WHAT IT DOES — AND DOESN'T — PROMISE

WHAT IT GUARANTEES

The rates are real

- No price the AI invents can reach a customer
- Every price on a sent quote is a real price-list figure
- If the numbers don't line up, the quote is pulled — never patched
- The customer gets a verified quote or an honest paid site visit

WHAT IT DOES NOT

The job size is judged

- Item counts and labour hours are the AI's read of the job
- The same job described differently can come out differently
- It is not yet a fixed calculator
- The price check allows small rounding tolerance

The honest summary: QuoteMax is **an AI estimator with a hard database price-check on the end**. Its reliability claim is specific and defensible — **the prices a customer sees are always real prices from the tradie's own list**.

THE AI DRAFTS IT • THE DATABASE VERIFIES IT • ONLY VERIFIED PRICES REACH THE CUSTOMER

Reflects the live QuoteMax estimating pipeline as at 21 May 2026. Dollar figures in the worked example are illustrative; the way each number is produced and checked is exact.